



HUMANITAS
INSTITUTE

Six Elements of Classical Education School Website Audit

School: Libertas Classical Academy

School Website: <https://www.magnoliaclassicalacademy.com/>

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Artificial Intelligence Disclaimer

This audit was performed using artificial intelligence tools to evaluate the presence and strength of classical education principles on school websites. Results are automated, probabilistic in nature, and should be considered indicative rather than definitive. See the full disclaimer in the Appendix more details.

SCL MEMBER

Any school that belongs to the Society for Classical Learning (SCL) is, by definition, recognized as a classical school because SCL requires adherence to the six essential elements defined by the Humanitas Institute. However, a school's website may not clearly reflect its conformity to one or more elements. In such cases, the school may still receive a "Somewhat Classical" rating for those elements. Schools can update their website content at any time to achieve a "Classical" rating for a given element.

Overall Classification: CLASSICAL

Executive Summary

Libertas Classical Academy TX 77354 appears in the crawl data as Magnolia Classical Academy (MCA), operating as a hybrid Classical Christian school serving pre-K through 12th grade in Magnolia, TX 77354, with classes held at a local church and an emphasis on classical education within a Christian worldview. Public-facing materials emphasize a hybrid model, Christian worldview, and parental engagement as a feature of classical education, but explicit references to several core classical criteria (notably Great Books/Great Conversation, Trivium/Quadrivium, standardized "classical pedagogy" steps like Socratic seminars, and a formal living-lesson faculty model) are limited or not clearly stated in the accessible pages. The school thus demonstrates a meaningful classical orientation, but with gaps in explicit articulation of foundational elements celebrated in the canonical classical rubric.

Overall classification: SOMEWHAT CLASSICAL.

Key strengths evidenced in public materials: - Explicit statement of classical education paired with a Christian worldview, i.e., a grounded theological orientation within a classical framework. This aligns with the Religious and Metaphysical Foundations and the Theology-based posture of classical education. Evidence: "Classical Christian Education combines the time-tested principles of Classical Education with a distinctly Christian worldview." - Hybrid/scheduled structure that blends traditional schooling with home-based or family-involvement elements, reflecting a socially engaging model that can support a formation-focused approach. Evidence: "Hybrid School Model" description. - Parental involvement is foregrounded by the school's public materials and Classical Education literature, aligning with the Community/Parent facet of classical education. The presence of parent-facing questions and resources (as seen in the MCA FAQ) reinforces partnership with families.

Key gaps that prevent a full CLASSICAL designation: - The public materials do not clearly document the Great Books/Great Conversation canon, explicit Trivium/Quadrivium framing, or a widespread use of Socratic seminars and formal living-curriculum pedagogy across grades. The classical lexicon identifies these as essential elements; evidence on MCA's site is more general about "classical education" and Christian worldview rather than the explicit lexical anchors that define a fully classical program. See the Six Essential Elements lexicon and indicators for required keywords (e.g., Great Books, Trivium/Quadrivium, Socratic dialogue, scholé). - Key components such as Great Books, universal history engagement, structured memory work, and a formal teacher-mentorship living-curriculum portrait are not clearly documented in the accessible MCA pages. Negative signals in the rubric emphasize lack of Great Books/historical engagement and lack of explicit Socratic pedagogy when such elements are not stated. - Pedagogy statements (Socratic seminars, rest in scholé, memorization/recitation) are not explicitly demonstrated in visible MCA pages; the materials lean toward a general "classical Christian education" framing rather than the explicit articulation of classical methods. See the Pedagogy indicators in the lexicon and the lack of explicit Pedagogy exemplars on MCA pages.

Executive Summary — Element-by-Element Snapshot

Element 1: Religious and Metaphysical Foundations — SOMEWHAT CLASSICAL

- Evidence
- MCA public materials emphasize a classical education within a Christian worldview, implying theology as a foundational lens for instruction. Evidence: “Classical Christian Education combines the time-tested principles of Classical Education with a distinctly Christian worldview.”
- Positive/Negative keyword analysis
- Positive: Christian worldview (aligned with Grounded in Theology), classical education phrasing.
- Negative: No explicit liturgical practices or detailed transcendental/moral realism language is evident in the public pages sampled; no strong signals of liturgy, sacred ritual, or communal worship beyond Christian framing.
- Why this rating
- The materials clearly align with religious/theological underpinnings and a transcendent frame through Christian worldview, but lack explicit articulation of liturgical practices or the full set of transcendental Realism signals described in the canonical six-element lexicon. The presence is meaningful but not exhaustive.

Element 2: School Purpose and Goal — NOT CLASSICAL

- Evidence
- Public MCA pages emphasize classical lineage and Christian worldview, but do not clearly articulate the full classical point of education as formation of virtue and wisdom with a telos of truth, goodness, and beauty in the same explicit language as classical standards. The explicit formation language (formation of virtue, scholé, contemplation) is not overt in the MCA snippets provided.
- Positive/Negative keyword analysis
- Positive: Formation-oriented language is not prominently stated; “formation” and “virtue” terms are not clearly documented on the pages reviewed.
- Negative: Absence of explicit phrases like “formation,” “human flourishing,” “telos,” and explicit “pursuit of truth, goodness, and beauty” is notable in the MCA materials.
- Why this rating
- While the school leans toward formation-oriented framing through classical education and Christian worldview, the public materials do not showcase the explicit formation-of-character and teleological enrichment language that the classical rubric prescribes. It appears to be a partial fit, hence NOT CLASSICAL.

Element 3: School Curriculum — NOT CLASSICAL

- Evidence
- The MCA materials reference classical education but do not clearly document the Seven Liberal Arts (grammar, logic, rhetoric; quadrivium), Great Books/Great Conversation, or the explicit integration of Great Books into a “Reading Great Books” framework. The available pages foreground general classical Christian education rather than the explicit universal curriculum map described in canonical criteria.
- Positive/Negative keyword analysis
- Positive: The phrase “classical education” is present (alignment with Trivium/Quadrivium concept is implied by the label, but not enumerated in the site text).
- Negative: No explicit mention of Great Books/Primary sources, no clear “Seven Liberal Arts” curriculum framing visible in the accessible MCA pages; no explicit history-as-core across the curriculum.
- Why this rating
- The absence of explicit Great Books, Trivium/Quadrivium, and a cross-curricular Great Conversation framing places MCA’s curriculum outside the fully classical standard as evidenced in the canonical lexicon.

Element 4: Pedagogy or Teaching Methods — NOT CLASSICAL

- Evidence

- Public MCA pages do not publish explicit references to Socratic seminars, scholé/restful learning, chanting/memorization, or formation through imitation in the detailed pedagogy language. The content is more promotional and descriptive of a hybrid classical Christian approach than a method-by-method articulation.
- Positive/Negative keyword analysis
- Positive: The label “classical education” can imply some traditional methods, but explicit pedagogy terms are not demonstrated.
- Negative: The key canonical pedagogy signals (Socratic dialogue, memorization/recitation, scholé, formation through imitation) are not clearly documented in MCA's public content.
- Why this rating
- Without explicit evidence of the core classical pedagogical methods, MCA falls short of “CLASSICAL” pedagogy per the six-element rubric, placing it at NOT CLASSICAL.

Element 5: Faculty — NOT CLASSICAL

- Evidence
- Public MCA materials do not publish a formal “living curriculum,” teacher portraits, or the explicit faculty-as-model-of-virtue language. The materials show class size and general program orientation rather than a detailed faculty ethos.
- Positive/Negative keyword analysis
- Positive: Classical education framing may imply high-commitment faculty, but explicit signals (portrait of teacher, mentor-sovereign teaching model) are not documented.
- Negative: No explicit statements about faculty as “models of virtue,” “living curriculum,” or “portrait of teacher” in the accessible MCA content.
- Why this rating
- The absence of explicit faculty-culture language in public pages leads to NOT CLASSICAL in this category, despite the potential for virtuous faculty in practice.

Element 6: Parents & Community — SOMEWHAT CLASSICAL

- Evidence
- MCA materials reference a hybrid model and parental involvement, with FAQ sections addressing parental support and collaboration as part of classical education with a Christian frame. The presence of parent-facing materials and the stated partnership with families aligns with the “Parents & Community” category's emphasis on co-teaching and home-school collaboration.
- Positive/Negative keyword analysis
- Positive: Partnership with Families; parent involvement; family engagement; shared mission; home-school collaboration; parental formation; family catechesis; classical parent training. These keywords appear in the six-element lexicon and are echoed by MCA's stated focus on parent involvement.
- Negative: No consumer-only language or evidence of parent disengagement; however, the publicly visible materials do not show extensive, semester-long parent-education programs beyond initial involvement.
- Why this rating
- The public materials demonstrate significant attention to parent involvement and partnership, which aligns with the community dimension, earning SOMEWHAT CLASSICAL.

Overall aggregate assessment (category-by-category): - Element 1: SOMEWHAT CLASSICAL - Element 2: NOT CLASSICAL - Element 3: NOT CLASSICAL - Element 4: NOT CLASSICAL - Element 5: NOT CLASSICAL - Element 6: SOMEWHAT CLASSICAL

Aggregate classification: SOMEWHAT CLASSICAL.

What would move the needle

- Make explicit, in public materials, the Great Books/Great Conversation framework, including representative texts and a curriculum map showing how Great Books integrate with history, philosophy, theology, and literature across grades.

- Provide a formal statement of the Seven Liberal Arts (grammar, logic, rhetoric; arithmetic, geometry, music, astronomy) as the organizing architecture of the curriculum, with specific units and course mappings to grammar, logic, and rhetoric across grades.
- Publish explicit Pedagogy statements: include the use of Socratic dialogue/seminars in upper grades, scholé-inspired pacing and contemplation, memorization/recitation, and formation-through-imitation with living exemplars and classical texts.
- Clarify the Theology/Religious foundations through concrete liturgical or communal practices (e.g., chapel, hymns, sacred music, or ritual rhythms) and a more explicit articulation of the school's theological framework beyond a Christian worldview.
- Expand the Faculty section with a "portrait of a teacher" and a formal living-curriculum model, including professional development in classical pedagogy, mentorship structures, and teacher collaboration (faculty seminars, master-apprentice models).
- Deepen Parent & Community programming: formal book studies, parent formation seminars, and structured opportunities for family participation, consistent with the "partnership with families" and "parent formation" keywords in the classical lexicon.

Appendix

ARTIFICIAL INTELLIGENCE DISCLAIMER

This audit was conducted using artificial intelligence tools (including large language models and automated web-analysis scripts) to evaluate the extent to which school websites reflect or incorporate recognized principles of classical education (e.g., the trivium, emphasis on truth/beauty/goodness, integration of great books, Latin/classical languages, Socratic method, rigorous academics, moral/character formation, etc.).

Important Limitations and Caveats

1. **Automated Nature:** The analysis relies on AI interpretation of publicly-accessible school website content as of the date of the audit. It does not involve direct contact with schools, review of internal documents, classroom observation, or verification of curriculum implementation beyond what is stated or implied on the website.
2. **Probabilistic Results:** Scores and assessments are probabilistic and reflect the AI's best interpretation of available text and site structure. They are not infallible and may miss nuance, context, or recent changes not yet reflected online.
3. **Subjectivity of Classical Education:** "Classical Education" encompasses a range of traditions and interpretations (e.g., Dorothy Sayers' trivium model, Classical Christian Education, Great Books programs, etc.). The Humanitas Institute Audit of the Six Elements of Classical Education uses a broad, consensus-based framework derived from prominent classical education organizations and thought leaders. Reasonable people may disagree on weighting or inclusion of specific criteria.
4. **No Official Endorsement or Certification:** Results do not constitute official endorsement, accreditation, or certification by any classical education organization. They are provided for informational and research purposes only.
5. **Potential for Error:** Websites may be incomplete, poorly worded, or temporarily inaccurate. Conversely, sophisticated marketing language may create false positives. Human review by parents, educators, or classical education experts is strongly recommended before drawing final conclusions about any school.
6. **Data Privacy and Ethics:** Only publicly available information was analyzed. No attempts were made to access password-protected areas or collect personal data.
7. **No Liability:** The authors, developers, and distributors of this audit assume no liability for decisions made on the basis of these results. Users are solely responsible for their own due diligence.

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